

CONTACT INFORMATION	Full Name: Vaibhav Agarwal Date of Birth: 21/02/2002 Nationality: Indian Work: +358 040-625-5999 E-mail: vaibhav.agarwal@tum.de Website: econvaibhav.github.io	1 st year Doctoral Researcher AGAPP – TUS7AGP School of Social Sciences and Technology Technical University of Munich
ABOUT ME	Hello, I'm Vaibhav Agarwal, a passionate and hard-working first-year doctoral researcher at the Professorship for Algorithmic Governance and Public Policy at the Munich School of Politics and Public Policy, Technical University of Munich. I am interested in how algorithmic governance and digitalisation shape public trust, with a particular focus on the heuristics people use when making decisions. My research also explores methods and data suited to uncovering these patterns, especially conjoint experiments. Beyond this, I experiment with multimodal approaches that bring together text, audio, image, and video. I enjoy presenting my research in accessible and creative formats, ranging from presentations and articles to videos and posters. I have grown up in Bangalore, a city in Southern India, where I pursued my Bachelor of Arts in Economics with a minor in Data, Democracy, and Development from Azim Premji University. For my master's I traveled to Helsinki to study Social Data Science and graduated with a Master's in Social Sciences from the University of Helsinki. At present, I am starting my doctoral research at the Munich School of Politics and Public Policy at the Technical University of Munich, in Germany.	
EDUCATION	Technical University of Germany School of Social Sciences and Technology, AGAPP – TUS7AGP	September 2025 –
	University of Helsinki, Helsinki, Finland Master's in Contemporary Societies, <i>Social Data Science Track</i>	August 2023 to June 2025
	Azim Premji University, Bangalore, India Bachelor of Arts, Economics <i>Minor in Data, Democracy & Development Economics</i>	July 2020 to May 2023 GPA: 8.1/10
	Deens Academy, Bangalore, India High School Diploma, Commerce, General	July 2015- March 2020 AISSCE: 87%; AISSE: 89.6%
MASTER'S THESIS	Social Data Science, University of Helsinki <i>Evaluation of Algorithmic Systems in Public Governance: Testing Methodological Cohesion in Conjoint Analysis</i> • Examining public perceptions of algorithmic decision-making (ADM) systems with a focus on understanding trust and legitimacy. • Exploring how conjoint experiments can reveal nuanced patterns in human decision-making; as well as, comparing standard estimation methods (Marginal Means, AMCE, ACP) and applying latent class analysis to investigate attribute non-attendance.	
METHODS FAMILIARITY	Conjoint Experiments and Social Media Analysis (YouTube, Instagram and TikTok), Multivariate Analysis, Machine Learning, Representation Learning	
SKILLS SUMMARY	Python, R, STATA, tidyverse, Pandas, Matplotlib, Geopandas, Numpy, Beautiful Soup, Selenium, EasyOCR, NLTK, spaCy, Hugging face, Transformers, CSC server, Puhti, Allas, OpenCV.	

CONFERENCES

- **Short Presentation – DHNB2025 ‘Digital Dreams and Practices’**
5th to 7th March 2025 | Digital Humanities in the Nordics and Baltics
Applying Self Organizing Maps (SOM) to PERMA-H Framework: Analysing Well-Being Expressions in Suomi24 Online Discussions
Authors: Mahdi Munshi, Vaibhav Agarwal, Viivi Pentikäinen & Krista Lagus
- **Poster and Oral Presentation – Azim Premji University Student Research Conclave**
17th March 2023 | Azim Premji University
Poster Presentation – Development of Accessible and Comprehensible Data Visualizations
Oral Presentation – Computing the Impact of Investment in Renewable Energy Projects on Output Growth of Developing Countries (Published at [SRC Journal](#))

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

University of Helsinki – Faculty of Social Sciences

January 2024 – July 2025

- *Research Assistant – AGAPP Project (January 2025 – July 2025):*
 - AGAPP (continued): Working with new datasets and learning methods involving control/treatment group designs; conducting a literature review on estimands and emerging themes in public perceptions of algorithmic systems.
- *Research Assistant – AGAPP & HEPP Projects (June 2024 – December 2024):*
 - AGAPP (Algorithmic Governance - A Public Perspective): Understanding conjoint experiments and creating clean pipelines to run standard conjoint experiment methodologies (MM, AMCE, ACP); testing applicability of utility and cognitive modeling based approaches, such as RRM, DFT and ANA to understand human behavior from conjoint experiments.
 - HEPP (Helsinki Hub on Emotions, Populism and Polarisation): Utilized Puhti and Allas for storage, analysis and code execution, helping managing 3 TB of data; video and auditory analysis using OpenCV and whisper; Named Entity Correction for political actors in messy qualitative research notes from 10 European countries.
- *Teaching Assistant – Quantitative Research Skills (September 2024 – October 2024):*
 - Teaching Assistant for the Quantitative Research Skills course offered by Kimmo Vehkalahti. Had the opportunity to interact with students from various disciplines and support them with R programming and common quantitative research methods, such as factor analysis and regression.
- *Research Assistant – Data Wrangling and Visualization (January 2024 – February 2024; April 2024 – May 2024):*
 - April 2024 – May 2024: Worked approximately 40 hrs on wrangling survey data (wide to long), setting up models for AMCE/MM estimation, and analyzing feature prevalence across conjoint experiments.
 - January 2024 – February 2024: Completed a short-term (30 hrs) contract focused on newly collected survey data; worked on data cleaning, transformation, and visualization.

Azim Premji University

March 2023 – October 2023

- *Research Assistant – Prachi Bansal (June 2023 to October 2023):*
 - Worked as a research assistant to estimate the state of care infrastructure in India. Responsibilities included - Web-scraping, Data Analysis, Literature Reviews, Collaborative Writing, Presentations and Data Visualisations.
- *Teaching Assistant – 4 Day Workshop on Statistics and R Programming for Visually Impaired Participants (March – April 2023):*
 - Teaching Assistant at Azim Premji University for a pioneering 4-day workshop designed specifically for visually impaired participants with a focus on teaching key statistical concepts and the R programming language, utilizing innovative pedagogical tools.

- *Social Audit Intern – Society for Social Audit, Accountability and Transparency (SSAAT), Telangana (May 2022 to June 2022):*
 - Witnessed the undertaking of the MGNREGA scheme (Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act) and helped facilitate social audits throughout Telangana (Kamsanpalli, Boopatipur, Sultanpur, Haveli Ghanpur). Additionally, spread awareness of worker's rights.

VOLUNTEER

- **Board Member – International Committee**
Helsingin yliopiston ylioppilaskunta - HYY
January 2024 - December 2024 | University of Helsinki
Responsible for the creation and maintenance of the IC Website and organisation of events. Additionally, advocating for international student rights, addressing issues such as tuition fees, scholarships, and employability.